

The Spirit of Religion II

Let us open to Luke 11 and begin with verse 27. I will pass in review briefly, I trust.

This is the chapter where the disciples asked Jesus to teach them how to pray. Of course, He taught them what we call the Lord's Prayer: "Our Father which art in heaven, hallowed be Thy name." Then He taught on praying down bread for somebody who does not know how to go to God and get it for themselves. Then He taught on Satan's war machine.

Now He is teaching on Himself as the answer to all of that, becoming the greater One, greater than Solomon and greater than Jonah.

We have been catching a glimpse, as much as we can understand in the born-again trail, into His glory. When He pulled me into the Spirit, I got my first look at it. I told you that as soon as He could unfold it enough to my understanding, I would begin to be able to teach on it accurately.

At that time it was in me. It was in my spirit, trying to come to my mind, but it was overpowering me. It was too much. I had the feelings from it. It was just too much. Now, as it is trickling through my mind and sorting itself out, I am able, more than I could two or three months ago, to teach on it line upon line.

Most recently, I have recognized where some of my emotions are coming from. The one thing I always understood to come from my spirit, which finally surpassed all circumstances, was peace. I knew that whatever caused me to be so calm and peaceful in the midst of all circumstances had to be that peace that emanates from your spirit. Sure enough, that is what it turned out to be.

As far as I knew, that was the only thing, if you could classify it as an emotion, that I understood to come from my spirit. It is a stillness. It is a stillness so calm and quiet, almost a stillness that is a deafening roar. The stillness is so loud, yet so quiet, that it drowns everything else out.

To understand it as anything I had ever had before, I really could not. But the further I get into it, the harder it is to explain to the natural mind. It is a resounding that is so loud it is a deafening roar, yet it most definitely supersedes everything. It is stronger than anything else that has ever come against me.

In the teaching on the rich man and Lazarus, people will say that people end up in hell full of revenge. But the rich man in torment was only interested in negotiating relief.

The moment he landed in hell and found out it was forever, the eternity of that moment settled in. Think of it. You are just landing in hell, and everything anybody has ever said, every Sunday school lesson, every hellfire-and-brimstone preacher you laughed at, every truth that was ever spoken, just runs through you.

The one thing you know, that deafening roar, resounds with permanence. It is so powerful when it settles in that you are here forever.

What good would it be to wish all your friends were there with you? All the rich man did was look across the great chasm and see Lazarus in Abraham's bosom. All he wanted was to negotiate just for a little water. But you can be sure eternity never becomes so powerful and so loud as it does in the moment when he knows there is no alternative: you are here for good.

Let me look at His glory for a moment. I have had some other kinds of feelings emanating from me, and I have never had them before except when I classified them as a gifting, such as the gift of faith, when for a moment an anointing came on you and you had God's faith to get somebody out of a wheelchair or overpower some situation.

But what has been coming on me and staying on me is different. I am having seasons of feelings that emanate through my whole soul and mind: I am a conqueror. Yes, it is all true. Yes, it is all yours. Can't you see it? Can't you feel it?

I slip into those times and wonder about myself. Why could I ever doubt it? Why did I have such trouble coming to this place? It makes me wonder how many people have touched it, even though there are things coming and going and I am slipping in and out of them.

I have never cried so much in my whole life.

The other realms were easy to slip into, but this one is something else.

While Jesus was teaching, they said, "Teach us to pray." He taught on the Lord's Prayer. He taught on praying down bread for people who do not know how to go to God. Then He taught on devils and unclean spirits when they go out of men.

Then He began to reveal why all of this was possible and who He was: the greater than Jonah, and, no matter how much wisdom Solomon had, greater than Solomon.

You have to understand, people were seeing a man standing there. They were seeing a man, and He was making statements like this. It is incredible.

I hear so many people teaching, "In My Father's house are many mansions," and we actually believe He is building some physical dwelling for us to live in. The descriptions of those dwellings, when seasons of teaching come through the body of Christ, get more vivid every time. I am not saying they are not real. I just do not know.

Diamond doorknobs, gold two-by-fours, all of it sounds great, but that does not interest me too much. I really do not care about that kind of dwelling. What I care about is how close I am to the Lamb when He wanders around heaven.

It just so happens that it was not golden two-by-fours He was talking about, but how close you are to the Lamb.

He said:

| In My Father's house are many mansions.

There are many rooms, many dwellings. "If it were not so," He said, "I would have told you." Something this important and major, He says, "If this were not so, I would have told you."

"In My Father's house are many rooms. I know because in My humanity as a Son of God, I occupy one of them. I occupy a room with My Father in His inheritance, in His house. In My humanity, I occupy a room with Him. I am His Son. But I have good news for the human race, in particular for you whom I am teaching. If it were not so, I would have told you. I go by way of the cross. I am going to prepare a place for you. If I go prepare this place for you, you can rest assured, I will come again and receive you unto Myself, that where I am, there you may be also."

"I go by way of the cross, and I will come again. In this room I occupy with the Father in My humanity as His Son, I will come again and receive you unto Myself. Where I am, in this room I occupy with Him as His Son, I will receive you unto Myself. You will become an heir of God. You will become a joint heir with Me. Where I am, there you will be also."

But He has good news for you while you are wandering around this planet. This is why John said you will have great boldness in the day of judgment:

As He is, so are we in this world.

He now occupies that room, that place with the Father at His right hand in a glorified body. He wants you to know that as He is in His humanity, in His spirit, in His position, and in all that authority He has there, that is the authority He had here. He wants you to know He had to leave you behind, but that is all right, because as He is, so are you in this world, if you can believe it.

He said:

All things are possible to him that believeth.

Those words have echoed through the generations of time, and so few have grasped them, particularly a group like us.

Gary was talking about how God had anything to do with you and me being born on this planet. There are more people alive on the face of the earth now than have ever lived and died since the flood. We do not know about before the flood, but afterward, there are more alive on the planet right now than have ever lived and died.

However you came to be born now, we do not really know. We know God had foreknowledge of it because He is God. But somehow you have been entrusted with the souls of more men than have ever lived and died.

Down through the generations, the words have always echoed:

All things are possible to him that believeth.

Anyone who picked up a script, then later through publishing companies and the printing press, and now through the media as never before, has seen those words spread and spread. The availability of revelation knowledge is at our fingertips in every language, in every translation. Just tap a few buttons.

In our generation those words are being echoed more, and to a larger population, than ever before.

Was it because God looked and saw potential in you, and therefore entrusted you with the masses? Is that why you were born now?

One thing is sure: those words echoed from Jesus' lips. They echoed from the lips of those who followed Him. They were found in the writings and later the testimony of the gospel. They were found in the pastoral epistles one way or another. The man who got hold of God, the man who made a connection and found out who he was and who God is, found that all things are possible.

The man who saw these things come to pass was not the man who wanted all the glory of God, all of who He is, and all His resources to serve himself. If you are guilty of that kind of greed, eventually a counterfeit will be slipped in, and you will not be serving the right spirit.

What did God make all things possible for? If you do not have a heart that cares about the person next to you going to hell, then you do not even have one-fourth of the heart of Jesus Christ.

Thank God, He said all things are possible to him that believes. You will never see the fullness of those statements until they are uttered from the heart of an absolute servant, one who has put himself at the slavery and disposal of God. All that he has and all that he is must be available.

I believe you are going to see it. I believe you are going to see it.

Amen. Thank God.

He said, "I am going to prepare a place for you, and I will come again and receive you unto Myself, that where I am, that is where you will find yourself."

All things have become possible to you.

The most exciting words I heard in my whole life were just the other day. He said, "Until you understand your inheritance, son, you are not going to cover this earth with what I gave you, because you will limit your ministry to limited men who have limited Me, who believe in legalism and that I am limited to their legalistic acts."

He said, "I am not. You have My name. You have My inheritance. All that heaven has is yours, and I want to get the world saved worse than you do. So if you do not mind taking the limit off, I do not mind doing My part."

Limited men have limited God. If a preacher has subjected himself to limited people who have limited God by their acts of legalism, then they are serving under a limited preacher who has limited God because his dependency is on people.

Hello, Abraham.

For a person to begin to operate in all of this and all of His glory, you have to understand who you are. You have to understand what He has given to you. What caused you to become His son is that He translated you out of darkness into the kingdom of His Son and light. In a moment of time, your spirit went from the nature of sin, a death nature, to receiving His nature, a new nature.

The whole thing is dependent on you learning how to operate out of that new nature.

He said amazing things to the Jew. Now that they were sons, because Jesus had just fulfilled the curse of the law and freed them from it to receive the adoption of sons, He said:

God hath sent forth the Spirit of His Son into your hearts.

That term was not talking about sending the Holy Spirit. He was saying, "I want you to know that now you are sons, and the same spirit Jesus had in Him, that human spirit He quickened from death to life, is the same kind you have in you. You are My son because the spirit of adoption has come. But I want you to know you are My son by nature. You have received My nature."

He says:

But now, after that ye have known God, or rather are known of God...

Israel knew God through His acts. They saw Him do things like part the Red Sea. But He says, "Now that you know God, or rather are known of Him..." Of course, He is aware of everyone, spiritually dead or not, generation after generation. But "known of Him" is talking about that new nature.

Now we have a new nature. We are His sons. We have become one with Him in that new nature.

So why turn again to the weak and beggarly elements and serve those things which by nature are no gods?

I have a new nature. I am not going to bow my knee to anything, not to money, not to another human being, not to days, not to anything. I have become a son of God. I have His inheritance. What I serve Him through is my new nature, because that is what put me in fellowship with Him, and that is what makes me like Him.

Glory be to God. Hallelujah.

I tell you, this will play with your head. But did you notice how your spirit turns on like a dynamo? Pretty soon you are not leaving here looking for the sick. You are saying, "Where are the dead people?"

He got loose Friday night and just started healing people. He started healing them all over the place. I had the best time with God. I just love to walk with God like that.

He was flowing through here, and it was a prayer night. What can you do? He was running off of me like sheets of water. Finally I just could not stand any more, and I went out into the crowd and started getting people I knew were sick.

I said, "Come here, little sweetie. Just take my hand."

She said, "My God, my brain is heating up."

What is wrong then? That is where her disease was.

Our little lady who sits in the back here with the cane and the muscular disease where her muscles were deteriorating, shaking, said, "I was laying on the floor, and my brain got hot."

I was thinking, "Mine is hot all the time."

Come on, people. Have you noticed that? There are a lot of people to help you on the not-being-liked side, so you might as well like yourself. You get plenty of help with the other side.

She came right up here and just kept standing there saying, "I want to talk."

"Okay."

She kept trying to get in. It is real hard to break in on a preacher. There is no breathing or anything, no pauses. If they pause, they talk breathing in so you will not interrupt them.

She said, "I want to say something."

"Okay."

"My brain got hot when I was on the floor, and that is where the problem is."

When you walk with Him all the time, it is when your walk is all mixed up and you live in double-mindedness that emotion is good. You like to come here and listen to this level of the Word. We love to live in it. But if you like to hear that and then go live another lifestyle out there, all that does is cause a lot of torment back and forth. You do not have as much fun as I do.

Hallelujah.

I like to take sinners with big mouths, get the devil off of them, and watch their eyes get about this big. That is fun.

One man's wrist had been broken, and he could not bend it.

"Good. You are God. You should be. How about my wrist?"

I said, "In Jesus' name. Yes, how about it?"

He said, "I cannot believe this."

I said, "Believe it."

Then he came to the meetings. You might as well live like that.

Hallelujah.

I remember I was in a restaurant, and a woman came running over because she had just been in a meeting.

"Pray for me, Brother Roberson. Pray for me."

I said, "Okay."

This is how I know you can cause disturbances in restaurants. She fell down on the floor and knocked chairs all over.

I said, "Do not worry about it. She is okay. She is just being healed, that is all."

They had something to talk about then.

Another time in a restaurant, this waitress was all crumpled and disheveled. I said, "Are you okay? Are you in pain?"

"Yes. I have a double shift. I have kids. My head is killing me."

I said, "We can make that go away. I know Someone."

I took her by the hand and prayed, and all the pain left her head. We left her a bigger tip than the whole group's food cost. When she got her tip and had no headache, the next day another waitress kept looking at us. We kept going back every night. Finally she got brave enough to come over and say, "My friend was in a whole lot of pain, and she said somebody prayed for her. Was that you guys? I noticed the way you are talking."

I said, "Last night?"

She said, "Yes."

"With the headache?"

"Yes. Was that you?"

I said, "Yes."

Then she started saying, "Well, this is wrong with me, and I have this problem. Could you pray for me?"

I said, "Sure."

If you have all of that with you, these signs shall follow them that believe. You are a believer. You cast devils out, heal the sick, and speak with new tongues. If these signs follow them that believe, and you are the believer, and the signs are following you, then who are the people getting healed?

Did you know that getting a miracle for somebody out there is the best tract you can hand them?

Hallelujah.

Do you not just love Him?

I am finding out how to fellowship with Him out of my new nature. After twenty-seven years of ministry, I am finally finding out how to enter into that kind of fellowship with Him, to give Him what He has wanted, what He saved us for, what He redeemed us for, what He restored us with that new nature for.

It put me in fellowship with Him. The kind of fellowship He offers us now is beyond this natural body that the first man Adam gave us. Yet my spirit is the same as it will be in heaven.

All this glory, all this presence, all these rights I have while I am in this body. I have the absolute privilege of fellowship with Him like I was already in heaven, and I have the privilege of walking around with Him doing signs and wonders to convince a dying world that He loves them with the love He loves me, and He loves me with the love He loved Jesus with.

That is when it gets exciting.

But to live a double-minded life is no fun. Come here and get convicted, go back in the world and get free. Come here and get convicted, go back in the world and get free. Do not even get convicted. Get free, free, free.

What kind of fun is that? If I were you, I would just jump in and swim until my feet touched nothing.

"Now, Chuck, what are you doing?"

I am warming up to these verses because they are heavy. I am warming up to them and to what we have to say out of Matthew 10, which is real exciting. But right now we are talking about that new nature. We are talking about His glory.

Let me show you something. Beginning in Luke 11:27:

And it came to pass, as He spake these things, a certain woman of the company lifted up her voice, and said unto Him, Blessed is the womb that bare Thee, and the paps which Thou hast sucked.

As then, so now, women really love to prophesy. "Your old men shall dream dreams, your young men shall see visions," and He said the women would prophesy. Thank God for it. They carried some of the heaviest prophecies our promises are based on: Mary, Elizabeth.

Hallelujah.

Here is another one about to prophesy. She said:

Blessed is the womb that bare Thee, and the paps which Thou hast sucked.

But Jesus corrected her:

Yea rather, blessed are they that hear the word of God, and keep it.

He said yes, then switched her focus. Rather, blessed are they that hear the Word of God and keep it. He is going to tell you why you will be more blessed for hearing the Word and keeping it.

If you continue in My Word, John recorded Jesus saying, then are you My disciples indeed. You will know the truth. You will follow Me through the cross. I will die and resurrect, and you will know the truth, and the truth will make you free.

The Jews said, "We be Abraham's seed, and were never in bondage to any man."

He said, "He that sins is the slave to sin, and the slave will not abide in the house of the Father forever. But he whom the Son sets free is free indeed," and will abide through that new nature in the household of the Father forever.

He corrected the woman and said, "Yes, rather." Switch your focus. More blessed are they that hear the Word of God and keep it.

Notice what spirit was at work there. It wanted to switch the glory off Jesus and onto whom? Onto Mary. That thing started way back then, and it succeeded. It almost took the world over at one time. Who better for the devil to divert worship to eventually than Mary herself as "the mother of God"?

Jesus said, spiritually speaking, "Who is My mother? Who are My brethren? Those who hear the Word of God and keep it."

He said, "Rather, more blessed are they that hear the Word and keep it." Why? For the same reason He told them a greater than Jonah is here, and the same reason He went on to say a greater than Solomon is here. He was about to take us where no man had gone, where no man could go. He was about to take us into the new nature.

Hallelujah.

Let us look at it:

But He said, Yea rather, blessed are they that hear the word of God, and keep it.

And when the people were gathered thick together, He began to say, This is an evil generation: they seek a sign; and there shall no sign be given it, but the sign of Jonah the prophet.

For as Jonah was a sign unto the Ninevites, so shall also the Son of man be to this generation.

The queen of the south shall rise up in the judgment with the men of this generation, and condemn them: for she came from the utmost parts of the earth to hear the wisdom of Solomon; and, behold, a greater than Solomon is here.

The men of Nineveh shall rise up in the judgment with this generation, and shall condemn it: for they repented at the preaching of Jonah; and, behold, a greater than Jonah is here.

Then He tells you why you will be more blessed for keeping it:

No man, when he hath lighted a candle, putteth it in a secret place, neither under a bushel, but on a candlestick, that they which come in may see the light.

Jonah was in the ship while they were all crying out to their gods. He said, "It is my fault that the ship is sinking. I am running from the living God of the Hebrews. Listen to me, men. Throw me overboard."

It is just like we threw Jesus overboard. As Jonah was in the belly of the whale three days and three nights, so must the Son of Man be in the center of the earth. Then He was resurrected and preached to the world, just as the whale spit Jonah out and he preached to the Ninevites. That is a sign.

Yet the one that fascinated me even more than the obvious sign of Jonah was the Queen of the South, the Queen of Sheba. She came from the uttermost parts of the earth to hear Solomon's wisdom, then went her way and lived in the wisdom of his words for the rest of her days.

The wisdom Solomon operated in, as we found out not too long ago, was a type of the wisdom available to you and me through the rebirth, when we are born again. Wisdom was to Solomon what your new nature is to your spirit.

Although Solomon could lead every person who heard him under the shadow right up to the edge of the rebirth, he himself was still limited to operating in the shadow and the type. He could not take anyone across that line, from death to life, to receive the nature of God, because it was not yet available.

Yet Jesus said:

Yea rather, blessed are they that hear the word of God, and keep it.

Why would we be more blessed? He gives the explanation in verse 33, though we have not understood exactly what He was talking about.

Just after He finishes talking about Jonah and the Queen of the South, and after He says a greater than Solomon is here, He says this in verse 33:

No man, when he hath lighted a candle, putteth it in a secret place, neither under a bushel, but on a candlestick, that they which come in may see the light.

That is the whole reason Jesus came. A greater than Solomon is here, right there in that verse.

Thank God for the Teacher, the Holy Spirit. Thank my Father God for assimilation, not taking a verse out of context, but devouring chapter after chapter through assimilation.

What is in that verse that would cause us to go from the type and shadow to the greater than Solomon?

Why does a man bring a candle into a dark room? Is it not so that where darkness once was, there will be light, and where that light is, darkness is dispelled and you can see?

What Jesus was saying is that your new nature is to your spirit what that candle was to that dark room. It becomes the light you walk by.

In the next verse, if that were not enough, He said:

The light of the body is the eye.

What lets light into your body? Close your eyes for a minute, and you will find out there is nothing but darkness. It does not matter that there is light all around you if there is nothing in your body that lets the light in.

So He was saying the new nature is to your spirit what your eyes are to your body. It causes you to be able to understand the things of God. It is the illumination of God. It is the light you walk by. It is your new nature, your availability to God, and the reason you can understand God.

Your nature is not your intellect. It is not your emotion. It is the part of you that understands God. Jesus is greater than Solomon because He gave that to you.

Wake up. Wake up.

As we have said so many times, He did not even leave you alone there. It is like a baby piranha adopted by a mother goldfish. She pulled his little diaper down and beat his little bottom every day, but she could not beat that piranha nature out of him. He just sneaked off and ate his friends.

One day mama piranha came back and ran mama goldfish off.

"Where are we going, Mama?"

"We are going down to the part of the Amazon where the cows cross."

"What are we going to do then, Mama?"

"We are going to strip all the flesh off their legs until they fall. Then we will eat them."

"You do not have to say any more. I have been sneaking off and doing that for years. My mom just called me a rebellious teenager."

"How did you know to eat them, little Jeffrey?"

"I do not know. I just knew what to do."

That is right. Nature is not your intellect. It is not your emotion. It is something in you by which you understand what you are and who you are.

Or take a big duck egg in a little mama hen's nest. They hatch out this funny-looking thing, and it runs around trying to scratch like a chicken. Finally they get close to the pond, and he makes a run for it and jumps in.

She says, "Come back! Come back, little chickie! Please come back. You are going to drown. Chickens cannot swim."

He is swimming all over.

"How did you know how to do that, little baby chickie?"

"I do not know, Mama. When I got close, everything about me told me I could do it, so I just jumped in and did it."

Even though you have a nature as a son of God, God said, "I am going to be sure about this." So the third Person of the Godhead stepped down into you as your Teacher, the power, and the earnest that you will inherit all that heaven is.

Then They said, "Is this enough?"

"I do not think so. They are going to prove it later. Although all that power is in them, some will be defeated, emotional-breakdown kind of people who cannot even stand up to life."

"Are you sure they have the Holy Ghost?"

"Yes, He is in there."

"Why can He not do anything?"

"They do not let Him."

"What are we going to do about this? Look at them. They worship rocks, poles with big heads carved on them, big noses. They worship anything, even compressed coal. What are we going to do?"

"I guess we are going to have to figure out some way to pray for them. We are going to have to figure out a way even to create the prayer."

"How are we going to do that?"

"Let me see. We ought to be able to come up with something. We are God. We have to do their praying for them because they are too ignorant."

"Okay. And they cannot even come up with a good prayer because they are too ignorant."

"Okay. The only thing I can think of is this: Holy Spirit, when You baptize them, You will have to bring prayers from heaven. Then You will have to pray in a language they will not understand while You are praying for them, because they will not think You are praying for the right thing. We will hide it from them until we build them up above all the garbage, and then we will show them."

"Do you think we will get some of them through?"

"I do not know. Look around the prayer center."

So He will do their prayer for them. The only thing He will need from them is what He has always needed from the human race: their authority. He will borrow their authority by passing the language through their spirit. Then He will tell them it will edify them and build them up in God.

"Do you think that is enough?"

"No. Half the church world is fighting it."

"You mean if we make it that easy, they still will not?"

"No. A lot of them will not. Some of them will get up and say you get weird by praying too much in tongues."

"Why?"

"Because you might lose your Mercedes. He may make you give it to a missionary."

Even with all that.

"Why do we not compile the canon of Scripture into one book and hand that to them? Do you think that will help? Then let us invent a digital system of storage with little switches that open and close gates, so small that you can put the whole Bible on a computer-sized chip along with the dictionary. Do you think if we get technology where much more information is available to them, they will make it?"

"I do not know. They will just use the technology to get whatever they want out of greed. More greed."

"Is there any hope?"

"Yes. Once in a while God will root out a group of people like us, and we will have the privilege of laying hold on Him and not turning loose until we find out what His heart is, what is important to Him, and become His servant, His slave. Then we find out things like the salvation of whole towns is possible."

Now we have a reason He will make you an entrepreneur.

Hallelujah.

I guess we did not quite make it over to Matthew 10, did we? I suppose we will next Sunday. There are some great things over there.

Turn over to Matthew 10 for a minute. I have three, actually two, more minutes. I will just tell you this much.

Look at verses 26 and 27:

Fear them not therefore: for there is nothing covered, that shall not be revealed; and hid, that shall not be known.

What I tell you in darkness, that speak ye in light: and what ye hear in the ear, that preach ye upon the housetops.

We plan on doing that.

He goes on to give you some things about why you can have a lot of confidence:

Fear not them which kill the body.

You do not have to fear them because of the previous verses.

What do you think He is talking about when He says, "What I speak to you in darkness, declare in light," and "What I spoke to you in the ear, in the closet, proclaim from the housetops"?

I can tell you. It is when Jesus gathered those around Him and taught them. Everything He spoke to them in darkness, while they were yet spiritually dead, one day they would proclaim in light through the understanding and revelation of that new nature.

He was telling them ahead of time, "You are not going to have to fear him who kills the body."

What He taught them while they were yet spiritually dead, they were going to declare in light out of that new nature to a whole world. In the verse before that, He guaranteed them that there would be nothing covered and nothing hidden that they would not understand in that day of declaration.

Then He goes on to tell you why you do not have to be afraid. Every hair on your head is numbered. Two sparrows are sold for one farthing, one sixteenth of a man's salary for a day.

He says, "Do you have some kind of problem? Do you believe they are worth more than you? I know the number of hairs on your head. Are you having some kind of problem believing I will meet your need? Do you understand that you will be proclaiming with thorough understanding what I have given to you? Do you not understand that you do not have to take thought? You are My sons and My daughters. What is your problem?"

How long did it take you to develop that kind of worry?

His glory. His glory.

Hallelujah.